CHAPTER 4

NATURE OF SUGGESTIONS

Suggestible vs. Gullible

Suggestible and gullible are related but distinct concepts:

1. Suggestible refers to a person's ability to be influenced by suggestions, ideas, or external cues. It means someone is open to new information or perspectives and may be more likely to change their behavior or beliefs based on what they are exposed to. Being suggestible is a normal psychological trait and can be a helpful tool in areas like learning, creativity, and therapy. Suggestibility does not imply a lack of critical thinking, but rather an openness to influence.

2. Gullible, on the other hand, refers to a person who is easily deceived or tricked, often due to a lack of discernment or critical thinking. A gullible individual tends to believe things too readily, even when the information may be misleading, false, or irrational. While suggestibility involves openness to influence in a constructive way, gullibility suggests a vulnerability to manipulation or exploitation.

In summary:
• Suggestible people are open to new ideas and influences in a balanced way.
Responding to Suggestion
• Gullible people are overly trusting and can be easily deceived, often without questioning the validity of what they're told.

Responding to Suggestion:

People respond to suggestion in varying ways, and some individuals are more responsive than others. The level of response to suggestion is determined by the individual and can

change
depending on factors like emotional state and environment. At any given time, individuals have
the ability to accept or reject a suggestion, and this decision can happen either instantly or
gradually.

Instantly Accepting Suggestions:

Some people respond to suggestions immediately, especially
when there is a strong desire or emotional state influencing them. For example, entering a hospital
or medical setting can trigger a trance-like state in some individuals, leading to an immediate
response to suggestions. In these situations, formal hypnosis is not always necessary for the
suggestions to be effective. The environment and state of being play a key role in how a person
responds.

Gradually Accepting Suggestions:

Suggestions can also take hold gradually. This can happen
through repeated exposure or compounding suggestions, where each suggestion builds upon the
previous one. A common technique is to start with simple, easy-to-accept suggestions and slowly
build on them. Repetitive, open-ended suggestions like "Every day in every way, I am getting
better and better" can also lead to gradual change.

Taking Responsibility:

Individuals are ultimately responsible for how they think and respond to
suggestions. They have the power to accept or reject any suggestion, and no one can be made to
do anything against their core beliefs, values, or desires solely through suggestion. The level of
response to suggestion is often linked to the individual's level of desire and willingness to change.

Inner Lie Detector:

“I am a woman.” (And notice how you feel in your body.)
"I am a man." (And notice how you feel in your body.)
“I am breathing in air." (Notice how you feel in the body.)
"I am breathing in charcoal dust." (Notice how you feel in the body.)

Beliefs and Selective thinking:

Beliefs play a major role in how suggestions are accepted. These beliefs are often shaped by upbringing, culture, and experiences. People tend to filter incoming suggestions based on whether they align with their existing beliefs, and they are more likely to accept suggestions that fit their view of themselves and the world.

How to Deliver Suggestions:

When delivering suggestions, confidence is key. The hypnotist must convey complete certainty that the suggestions will be accepted and acted upon. Doubt or uncertainty can undermine the effectiveness of the suggestion. The delivery should be calm, confident, and positive, with an emphasis on present or future positive outcomes. Hypnotists should also match the subject’s breathing and tone to establish rapport and deepen the suggestibility.

Pre-Hypnotic Suggestion (Pretalk):

The pretalk is essential to set expectations and clarify the goals of the session. It prepares the subject by explaining what to expect, dislodging any misconceptions about hypnosis, and creating a positive mental environment for the session. Educating the subject about hypnosis increases the likelihood of a successful experience.

Being in the Moment:

During the session, the hypnotist should speak in the present tense, affirming what is happening as it occurs. This helps deepen the rapport and keeps the subject engaged in the process. By acknowledging the subject’s progress and encouraging them to

continue, the hypnotist reinforces a sense of well-being and relaxation, helping to deepen the
state of hypnosis and maximize the effectiveness of the suggestions. In summary, people respond to suggestion differently, and the ability to accept or reject suggestions is influenced by desire, beliefs, environment, and state of being. Effective suggestion
delivery requires confidence, positive reinforcement, and a deep understanding of the subject's
needs and state of mind.

Post-Hypnotic Review

Once the experience is complete, discuss what happened.
“Now tell me about that.”
“Kind of surprised yourself? Tell me about that.”
“Is there anything that sticks out from your experience that you would like to share with me?
“Is there anything you found particularly interesting?”
“Is there anything you observed or experienced that sticks out for you?”

Compounding Suggestions

"Go deeper into droopy, drowsy slumber as your eyelids get heavy and close and you go deeper into the knowing."
“The use of and, as, and but correlates the ideas into one thought.”
“The eyes generally blink with each new thought.”
“As you breathe /pause/, the rising and falling of the rib cage /pause/ gives all the internal organs /pause/a beautiful massage /pause/and you know /pause/, you know how /pause/how good /pause/ a good massage feels."
“You are breathing. Your rib cage is rising and falling with each breath. The movement of your rib cage is massaging the internal organs. You know. You know how. Massage feels good. Feel. Breathing feels good.Breathing massages the internal organs,” etc. “Anything I do will increase your _____ (relaxation, relationship, numbness, forgetfulness, studying, test taking, awareness, sporting performance, anesthesia . . . etc.).”

Post-Hypnotic Suggestion

A post-hypnotic suggestion is any suggestion made during a hypnotic trance that the individual will
carry out after the trance has ended. This type of suggestion can take effect immediately, after

some time, or sometimes not at all. The response to post-hypnotic suggestions depends on the individual's inner desires and willingness to accept or reject the suggestion.

Waking Suggestion

Waking suggestions are made during normal waking consciousness, without formal hypnosis or trance induction. These suggestions are effective even without a hypnotic state, as they can still bypass the critical, analytical mind. The response to waking suggestions is not limited to a trance state, and individuals can be influenced by them throughout daily life. For example, a child feels better after a mother kisses a scraped knee because the child believes and accepts the suggestion that it will heal. Waking suggestions also occur in advertising, media, and social interactions, where external cues influence thoughts and behavior.

Waking Trance

A waking trance occurs when individuals are in a relaxed, receptive state due to environmental factors or external influences, such as being in a hospital or hearing certain comments. In these situations, people are more likely to accept suggestions because their critical faculties are bypassed. For example, a person may feel hotter after hearing someone mention how hot the weather is. Waking trance often involves the acceptance of suggestions either by agreeing with them or by not actively rejecting them.

Rejecting Suggestions

Everyone has an inner sense of knowing, which helps them filter suggestions. If a suggestion is perceived as harmful, or goes against deeply held beliefs or values, it will be rejected. The subject may ignore the suggestion, shut down any further suggestions, or mentally alter the suggestion to

fit their own perception. This highlights the importance of the subject's personal awareness and
ability to selectively choose which suggestions to accept.

BLESSINGS SCHOOL OF HYPNOSIS